ction No:

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

ID: _____

Name: _____

Faculty of Business Studies

HRM206

Staffing Organization

Final/Version B

Fall 2025-2026

12/January/2026

Number of Exam Pages: 6 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

1. Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2. Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
3. This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4. This Final Exam will be marked out of 100 marks and is worth 50% of the total mark.
5. Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except for graphs/sketches.
6. Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phone during th examination.
7. Any work crossed through will **NOT** be marked.
8. Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

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Question No.	Mark	Marker's Signature
Q1		
Q2		
Q3		
Q4		

ments (FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY):

Total: ____ / 100

Final M

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Mini Case Study: Hiring Without Structure: Smart Tech Solutions

Smart Tech Solutions, a fast-growing tech company, is looking to hire a **Marketing Executive** to lead their expansion in the region. This role is really important for their future. Many people applied, and a lot were nvited for interviews. However, the HR team is worried about how they're doing the interviews.

Here's how they're currently hiring:

- **Lack of Formal Assessment:** They don't use any tests or written assignments related to the job. They just rely on talking to people face-to-face.
- **Highly Casual and Unstructured Interviews:** The interviews are very informal and don't follow any plan. Interviewers just have general chats, asking whatever comes to mind. This means every candidate's interview is different.
- **Absence of Documentation and Scoring:** Interviewers aren't taking notes during or after interviews. They also don't use any set scoring system to judge answers, making it hard to compare candidates fairly.
- **Emphasis on Subjective "Fit":** One main hiring manager keeps saying they want someone "who gives a good vibe." They care more about personal chemistry and liking someone instantly than about their actual skills or experience. This personal feeling strongly affects who gets considered.
- **Personal Preference Dictates Selection:** In the end, the person chosen for the Marketing Executive job is mostly picked because the hiring manager personally likes them, not based on their skills, experience, or any real data.

e HR department at Smart Tech Solutions isn't comfortable with this way of hiring. They see it as unfair l worry they might miss out on truly good candidates. But even with these concerns, they went ahead and ered the job.

Answer all the following Questions:

1. When selecting an appropriate assessment method for prospective candidates, what key criteria should be considered before finalization? Discuss with the aid of a relevant example. (20 Marks)

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2. Drawing upon the Smart Tech Solutions case, discuss the advantages and disadvantages of both structured and unstructured interviews in the hiring process. Which interview approach would you recommend for Smart Tech Solutions' future hiring, and why? (30 Marks)

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3. Based on the provided case study, identify and explain three specific weaknesses in Smart Tech Solutions' current candidate assessment process. (30 Marks)

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4. Drawing from best practices in external candidate assessment, recommend two specific improvements for Smart Tech Solutions' hiring process. (20 Marks)

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